

Memorandum

To: Dr. Ernest Gibson, Dr. Derek Ross, Dr. Susan Youngblood
From: Jolisa Brewster
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Subject: Infographic Analysis
Keywords: audience, design, theories, typography, visual communication

Purpose

This analysis highlights the methods and applied theories used in Dr. Stewart Whittemore's graduate course - Document Design - for an infographic poster. This project was an individual assignment, and examines the goals, as well as the visual, communicative and design choices that guided the development of this final artefact.

Audience and Context

The intended audience for this document was Auburn University students; the primary objective of the design was to raise awareness of "period poverty" through an infographic poster. The design process was grounded in document design principles, emphasizing the importance of presenting information clearly and effectively for a specific audience. Document design focuses on how information is crafted to enhance readers' understanding, which guides decisions about layout, hierarchy, and clarity (Kimball & Hawkins, 2007). In addition, the integration of text and visuals played a central role, reflecting Welhausen's (2024) view that these elements work together to convey meaning in a deliberate way. Applying these principles, I developed and sketched concepts for the poster, ensuring that concise language and impactful imagery worked together to effectively communicate the message effectively to the intended audience.

Theory and Application

Design elements were intentionally selected to enhance the logical flow and support efficient content analysis, drawing on established principles of document design. Design principles guide how visual elements are combined to create meaningful patterns for users (Kimball & Hawkins, 2007) which informed my decisions about structure and organization throughout the poster. Emphasizing functionality, the design also reflects Cairo's (2013) argument that visuals communication should prioritize clarity and usability above all else. By carefully integrating visuals, the poster reduces cognitive effort and supports audience comprehension. In line with this approach, key design principles identified by Kimball and Hawkins (2007), such as contrast, colour, position and size were applied to create a cohesive, visual document that effectively communicates the intended message.

Typography

Typography is one of the most impactful elements in design, as choice of fonts, text size, and formatting directly influences how easily and audience can process information. Drawing on Brumberger's (2003) concept of rhetorical typography which highlights the need to understand visual language through conscious attention to how typographic elements relate to each other, I was guided by that perspective when deciding font selections, ensuring that they were applied not only to convey information clearly but also to shape the tone and meaning. The typography contributes to the overall organization of the poster, establishes hierarchy and guides the reader's attention.

Conclusion

Ultimately, document design strengthens the effectiveness of technical communication by combining visual organization with clear writing. It allows readers to navigate complex information efficiently and apply it successfully in real-world tasks. By carefully considering layout, typography, visuals and structure, I was able to apply elements to create a cohesive and communicative document tailored to its target audience.

References

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